

DENEb:

THE STORY BEHIND MEXICO'S ROSWELL

By Noe Torres and Ruben Uriarte

In the early 1980s, rumors began circulating about a mid-air collision between a UFO and a small plane in 1974 near Coyame, Chihuahua, Mexico. The eerie tale seemed at first like a soft whisper in the wind, and, in those pre-Internet days, very few UFO researchers heard about, or paid much attention to, what would eventually be regarded as the most amazing UFO crash retrieval case since Roswell. The late Leonard H. Stringfield, one of the first researchers to focus on UFO crash retrievals, said in 1994, "I heard of the Chihuahua case before, either in the late 1970s or early 1980s. The only detail I vaguely recall is that a U.S. military team had covertly crossed into Mexico to retrieve the object."



Leonard Stringfield, First Coyame Researcher (U.S. Gov't Photo)

In the early 1990s, the story of the 1974 Coyame UFO crash began spreading like wildfire as a communication revolution took place in America. It was the advent of electronic bulletin board (BBS) systems, a precursor to Internet chat rooms, blogs, and forums. For the first time, people from all walks of life, using a personal computer and a simple computer modem, could dial into a host computer system to share and discuss information on any topic. Suddenly, vast amounts of textual data could be easily exchanged among users. It was within this "brave new world" that UFO researchers began sharing and discussing the stunning Coyame story.

In 1992, an intriguing document titled *Research Findings on the Chihuahua Disk Crash*, began appearing on electronic bulletin board systems that specialized in UFO case information. The document, which has since been dubbed *The Deneb Report*, carries a release date of 1992 and attributes its authorship to someone identified only as JS. The mysterious JS states that he is addressing the message to "All Deneb Team Members."

Although the origin of this document remains unknown, the use of the word "Deneb" may be an important clue. A highly luminous blue star in the constellation Cygnus, Deneb (Alpha Cygnus) has significance in astronomy, astrology, UFOlogy and also in speculative fiction. Scientifically speaking, Deneb (Alpha Cygnus) is a highly luminous blue star in the constellation Cygnus. It is, in fact, one of the brightest objects in the night sky. According to Astronomy.com, Deneb is a supergiant star that "pumps out enough light to equal 60,000 Suns" and is approximately 1,630 light years away from Earth.

Ironically, Deneb is often mistaken by ground observers for a UFO, and its presence in the night sky is sometimes used as a reason for explaining away UFO sightings.

Probably due to its imposing presence in the night sky, Deneb appears in several important works of science fiction. Isaac Asimov used Deneb as a setting in several of his short stories, most notably “The Feeling of Power” (1958) and “The Machine That Won the War” (1961). Deneb is also mentioned in several episodes of *Star Trek: The Original Series*, including “Where No Man Has Gone Before,” “I, Mudd,” and “The Trouble With Tribbles.”

Deneb and Cygnus are said to have been of special significance to stargazers in ancient times. In a 2007 article in *Atlantis Rising*, Dr. Greg Little wrote, “The reason Cygnus was so important to the ancients is most easily answered by a previously mentioned fact. The brightest star of the Cygnus constellation is Deneb, which was the pole star 17,000 years ago. But there is an even more intriguing aspect to this. Cygnus lies at a critical juncture in the Milky Way known as ‘The Great Rift.’ It is at this spot that the Milky Way splits into two long sides with a dark, murky area dividing it. This precise location of the Milky Way has served as a key component in many ancient religious systems. The most mysterious and important religious beliefs held by ancient people concerned the origin and destiny of souls. The Milky Way and The Great Rift are the specific geographic locations central to ancient beliefs about the soul.”

Mayan shamans in southern Mexico referred to The Great Rift as *the Xibalba be*, attributing to it a very special place in their cosmology. The *Xibalba be* was associated with the birth of all life – the very “center” of the galaxy. Paranormal researcher John Major Jenkins observes, “These processes and concepts are intimately involved in the understanding that the Milky Way is the Great Mother, and the dark rift is her vagina or birth place. It is the place of transformation that the prospective male king must enter in order to be reborn as the king, a divine being.” Because of these beliefs, Mayan astronomers were especially fixated on Cygnus and the heavenly bodies that shone all around the giant blue star Deneb.

On December 21, 2012, in a rare astronomical alignment, the winter solstice sun will appear right in the middle of The Great Rift. Jenkins explains, “At dawn on the winter solstice of A.D. 2012, the sun will be right in this dark-rift, and the orientation is such that the Milky Way rims the horizon at all points around. Thus, the Milky Way ‘sits’ on the earth, touching it at all points around, opening up the cosmic sky portal. The galactic and solar planes are thus aligned.” Students of ancient Mayan prophecies point out that 2012 is the end of the Mayan “Great Cycle” and may herald the end of human civilization.

Deneb and Cygnus are also prominent in UFO lore. According to the controversial “Serp” theories first collected by researcher Victor Martinez, Cygnus is said to be the origin of two of the five species of aliens that the U.S. government has observed visiting the earth. Serpo believers say that the U.S. government sent a military team of twelve humans on a visit to a planet in Zeta Reticuli as part of an extraterrestrial “exchange program.” The Serpo documents state that the U.S. government has “catalogued” three different species from Zeta Reticuli -- the Ebens, the Quadroids, and the Trantaloids; whereas two other catalogued species -- the Archquloids and the Heplaloids -- originate in the constellation Cygnus, near The Great Rift.

Given the prominence of the term “Deneb” among the ancient Mayans of southern Mexico and in recent UFO beliefs, the reference in the Deneb report is both striking and significant. As the report appears to be the work of U.S. government insiders with access to top secret documents, it seems clear that the word “Deneb” had special significance within these secret circles of UFO knowledge. It is possible that these insiders considered Deneb as the possible origin of some or all of the UFO occupants. It is also possible that this report was prepared for the benefit of human agents who were in communication with representatives from Deneb.

The Deneb report’s author is identified only by the initials or acronym *JS*. The *JS* could either be someone’s actual initials or it may be an acronym standing for, perhaps, “Joint Staff,” “Joint Services,” “Joint Stars,” or “Journal Staff.” Students of this puzzling document continue to hope that more information will surface about its mysterious origins.

To more fully understand the Deneb Report, we will first closely examine the text of the actual document and then we will trace the "chain of custody" for the document once it made its appearance in 1992. Below is the full text of the narrative, as it first surfaced on BBS systems in the early 1990s:

FILE UF03263.

SUBJECT: THE CHIHUAHUA DISK CRASH

To: All Deneb Team Members
From: JS
Date: 23 Mar 92
Subject: Research Findings on the Chihuahua Disk Crash
Text:

On 25 Aug 74, at 2207 hrs, US Air Defense radar detected an unknown approaching US airspace from the Gulf of Mexico. Originally the object was tracked at 2,200 (2530 mph) knots on a bearing of 325 degrees and at an altitude of 75,000 feet, a course that would intercept US territory about forty miles southwest of Corpus Christi, Texas. After approximately sixty seconds of observation, at a position 155 miles southeast of Corpus Christi, the object simultaneously decelerated to approximately 1700 (1955 mph) knots, turned to a heading of 290 degrees, and began a slow descent. It entered Mexican airspace approximately forty miles south of Brownsville, Texas. Radar tracked it approximately 500 miles to a point near the town of Coyame, in the state of Chihuahua, not far from the US border. There the object suddenly disappeared from the radar screens.

During the flight over Mexican airspace, the object leveled off at 45,000 feet, then descended to 20,000 feet. The descent was in level steps, not a smooth curve or straight line, and each level was maintained for approximately five minutes.

The object was tracked by two different military radar installations. It would have been within range of Brownsville civilian radar, but it is assumed that no civilian radar detected the object due to a lack of any such reports. The point of disappearance from the radar screens was over a barren and sparsely populated area of Northern Mexico. At first it was assumed that the object had descended below the radar's horizon and a watch was kept for any re-emergence of the object. None occurred.

At first it was assumed that the object might be a meteor because of the high speed and descending flight path. But meteors normally travel at higher speeds, and descend in a smooth arc, not in "steps." And meteors do not normally make a thirty-five degree change in course. Shortly after detection an air defense alert was called. However, before any form of interception could be scrambled, the object turned to a course that would not immediately take it over US territory. The alert was called off within twenty minutes after the object's disappearance from the radar screen.

Fifty-two minutes after the disappearance, civilian radio traffic indicated that a civilian aircraft had gone down in that area. But it was clear that the missing aircraft had departed El Paso International with a destination of Mexico City, and could not, therefore, have been the object tracked over the Gulf of Mexico.

It was noted, however, that they both disappeared in the same area and at the same time.



Air Force Radar Installation, Circa 1974 (U.S. Air Force)

With daylight the next day, Mexican authorities began a search for the missing plane. Approximately 1035 hrs there came a radio report that wreckage from the missing plane had been spotted from the air. Almost immediately came a report of a second plane on the ground a few miles from the first. A few minutes later

an additional report stated that the second "plane" was circular shaped and apparently in one piece although damaged. A few minutes after that the Mexican military clamped a radio silence on all search efforts.

The radio interceptions were reported through channels to the CIA. Possibly as many as two additional government agencies also received reports, but such has not been confirmed as of this date. The CIA immediately began forming a recovery team. The speed with which this team and its equipment was assembled suggests that this was either a well-rehearsed exercise or one that had been performed prior to this event.

In the meantime requests were initiated at the highest levels between the United States and Mexican governments that the US recovery team be allowed onto Mexican territory to "assist." These requests were met with professed ignorance and a flat refusal of any cooperation.

By 2100 hrs [likely should be 1200 hrs], 26 Aug 74, the recovery team had assembled and been staged at Fort Bliss. Several helicopters were flown in from some unknown source and assembled in a secured area. These helicopters were painted a neutral sand color and bore no markings. Eye witness indicates that there were three smaller craft, very probably UH1 Hueys from the description. There was also a larger helicopter, possibly a Sea Stallion. Personnel from this team remained with their craft and had no contact with other Ft. Bliss personnel.



Simulation of Coyame UFO by Noe Torres

Satellite and reconnaissance aircraft overflight that day indicated that both the crashed disk and the civilian aircraft had been removed from the crash sites and loaded on flat bed trucks. Later flights confirmed that the convoy had departed the area heading south.

At that point the CIA had to make a choice, either to allow this unknown aircraft to stay in the hands of the Mexican government, or to launch the recovery team, supplemented by any required military support, to take the craft. There occurred, however, an event that took the choice out of their hands. High altitude overflights indicated that the convoy had stopped before reaching any inhabited areas or major roads. Recon showed no activity, and radio contact between the Mexican recovery team and its headquarters had ceased. A low altitude, high-speed overflight was ordered.

The photos returned by that aircraft showed all trucks and jeeps stopped, some with open doors, and two human bodies laying on the ground beside two vehicles. The decision was immediately made to launch the recovery team but the actual launching was held up for the arrival of additional equipment and two additional personnel. It was not until 1438 hrs that the helicopters departed Ft. Bliss.

The four helicopters followed the border down towards Presidio then turned and entered Mexican airspace north of Candelaria. They were over the convoy site at 1653 hrs. All convoy personnel were dead, most within the trucks. Some recovery team members, dressed bio-protection suits, reconfigured the straps holding the object on the flatbed truck, then attached them to a cargo cable from the Sea Stallion. By 1714 hrs the recovered object was on its way to US territory. Before leaving the convoy site, members of the recovery team gathered together the Mexican vehicles and bodies, then destroyed all with high explosives. This included the pieces of the civilian light plane which had been involved in the mid-air collision. At 1746 hrs the Hueys departed.

The Hueys caught up with the Sea Stallion as it reentered US airspace. The recovery team then proceeded to a point in the Davis Mountains, approximately twenty-five miles north east of Valentine. There they landed and waited until 0225 hrs the next morning. At that time they resumed the flight and rendezvoused with a small convoy on a road between Van Horn and Kent. The recovered disk was transferred to a truck large enough to handle it and capable of being sealed totally. Some of the personnel from the Huey's transferred to the convoy.



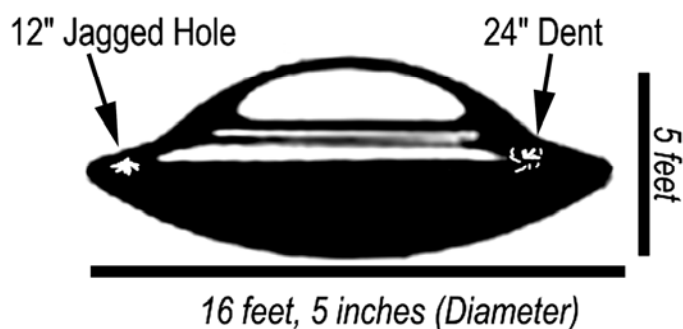
Sea Stallion Helicopters (U.S. Navy)

All helicopters then returned to their original bases for decontamination procedures. The convoy continued non-stop, using back roads and smaller highways, and staying away from cities. The destination of the convoy reportedly was Atlanta, Georgia.

Here the hard evidence thins out. One unconfirmed report says the disk was eventually transferred to Wright-Patterson AF Base. Another says that the disk was either transferred after that to another unnamed base, or was taken directly to this unknown base directly from Atlanta.

The best description of the disk was that it was sixteen feet, five inches in diameter, convex on both upper and lower surfaces to the same degree, possessing no visible doors or windows. The thickness was slightly less than five feet. The color was silver, much like polished steel. There were no visible lights nor any propulsion means. There were no markings. There were two areas of the rim that showed damage, one showing an irregular hole approximately twelve inches in diameter with indented material around it. The other damage was described as a "dent" about two feet wide. The weight of the object was estimated as approximately one thousand, five hundred pounds, based on the effect of the weight on the carrying helicopter and those who transferred it to the truck.

There was no indication in the documentation available as to whether anything was visible in the "hole."



Computer Simulation of Coyame UFO by Noe Torres

It seems likely that the damage with the hole was caused by the collision with the civilian aircraft. That collision occurred while the object was traveling approximately 1700 knots (1955 mph). Even ignoring the speed of the civilian aircraft, the impact would have been considerable at that speed. This is in agreement with the description of the civilian aircraft as being "almost totally destroyed." What was being taken from the crash site was pieces of the civilian aircraft.

The second damage may have resulted when the object impacted with the ground. The speed in that case should have been considerably less than that of the first impact.

No mention is made of the occupants of the civilian aircraft. It is not known if any body or bodies were recovered. Considering the destruction of the civilian light aircraft in mid-air, bodies may well not have come down near the larger pieces.

Unfortunately what caused the deaths of the Mexican recovery team is not known. Speculation ranges from a chemical released from the disk as a result of the damage, to a microbiological agent. There are no indications of death or illness by any of the recovery team. It would not have been illogical for the recovery team to have taken one of the bodies back with them for analysis. But there is no indication of that having happen. Perhaps they did not have adequate means of transporting what might have been a biologically contaminated body.

Inquires to the FAA reveal no documents concerning the civilian aircraft crash, probably because it did not involve a US aircraft.

It should be noted that the above facts do not tell the complete story. Nothing is known of the analysis of the craft or its contents. Nothing is known about the deaths associated with the foreign recovery team. Nor is it known if this craft was manned or not.

Other questions also remain, such as why would a recovered disk be taken to Atlanta? And where did the disk come from? It was first detected approximately 200 miles from US territory, yet US air defenses extend to a much greater distance than that. If the object descended into the atmosphere, perhaps NORAD space tracking has some record of the object. Alternate possibility is that it entered the Gulf of Mexico under radar limits then "jumped" up to 75,000 feet. Considering prior behavior exhibited by disks of this size, it is probable that the entry was from orbital altitude.

The facts that are known have been gathered from two eye witness accounts, documentation illegally copied, and a partially destroyed document. This was done in 1978 by a person who is now dead. Only in February of this year [1992] did the notes and documents come into the hands of our group.

[End of Document]

As the Deneb Report continued circulating on BBS systems in the early 1990s, paper copies of the document also began appearing in the mailboxes of key UFO researchers in the U.S. and Europe. In the summer of 1993, a copy of the report, mailed out anonymously, found its way into the hands of UFO activist Elaine Douglass, who at that time was an officer for the Washington, D.C. UFO group *Operation Right to Know*.



Elaine Douglass, Veteran UFO Researcher

Douglass, who holds a Master's degree in military policy from M.I.T., carefully examined the mysterious letter she discovered in her mailbox but could find no evidence of who sent it, other than a postmark from Santa Ana, California. Douglass thus became one of the very first civilian UFO researchers to examine an actual copy of the document.

In the book *Mexico's Roswell: The Chihuahua UFO Crash* (College Station, TX: VBW Publishing, 2007), Douglass gives, for the first time, a detailed analysis surrounding the events associated with her receipt of the document and her subsequent investigation of its contents. She believes that the "Chihuahua Disk Crash" report was created by employees within the government's intelligence community who gathered scraps of UFO-related information over many years. Although these individuals likely did not have sufficient security clearance to be "officially" in the know, they managed to collect important data, which eventually fit together perfectly, like pieces of a jigsaw puzzle. Despite not having access to any physical evidence from the Coyame UFO crash, these government employees, who referred to themselves as "Deneb team," managed to connect the dots and come up with the amazing scenario described in the *Research Findings on Chihuahua Disk Crash*. They then shared their findings within a small network of trusted acquaintances and possibly also used an electronic bulletin board system.

Douglass speculates that groups like the "Deneb team" exist within the government and that they collect and share information among their members regarding incidents such as the recovery of extraterrestrial artifacts. She feels certain that a number of people who have served in government are fully aware of the reality of UFOs. Further, there are individuals within government who seem determined to amass information about this topic, although their exact motives for doing so are not clear. One is left to wonder what their intent is, as very little of this information ever seems to come out into the public view.



Simulated UFO Set Against Actual Photo of Coyame Desert (by Noe Torres)

Douglass considers it critical to understand that government employees who stumble upon UFO secrets are, like all of us, curious human beings. Although they feel obligated to keep secret what they have learned, they are no less eager to learn more of the matter than we would be. From their vantage point, they are better able than we to recognize traces of governmental cover-ups, and occasionally, they may actually stumble across hard facts of a documented alien contact. Undoubtedly, these government employees are, like we, consumed by curiosity and transfixed by the importance of the topic of extraterrestrial visitations to Earth. However, unlike civilians, they cannot openly speak or write about what they know. Fear and implied threats keep them silent. So what can they do if they desire to reveal what they know? According to Douglass, the answer to this question may lie in the Deneb team's report.

Douglass characterizes the Deneb team as a "quiet little informal study group" composed of like-minded government employees seeking to uncover the truth about a specific UFO incident. She feels these types of informal study groups may be a typical method used by groups of trusted acquaintances to

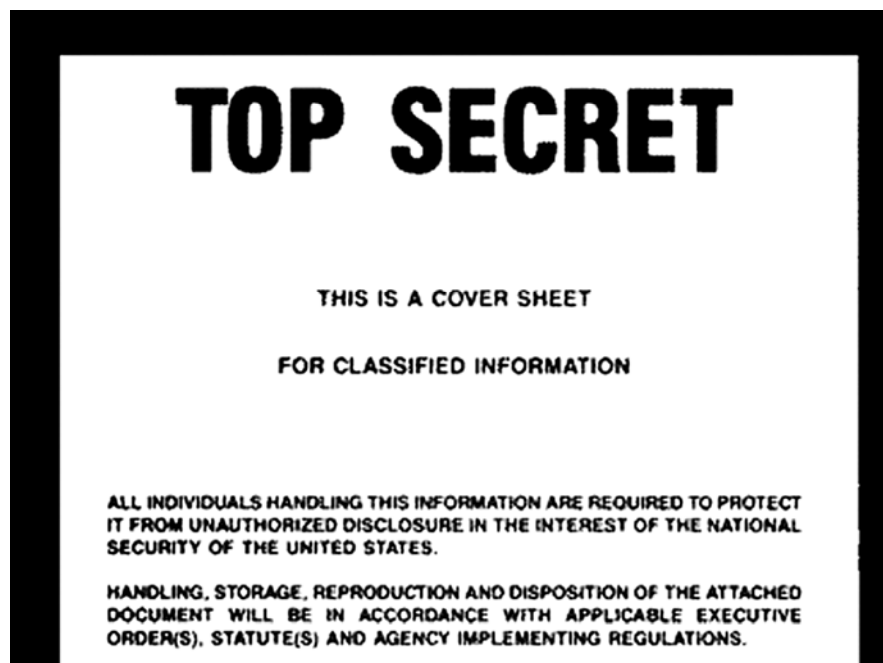
discuss and share what they have learned about UFOs. These groups, operating with great secrecy and anonymity, also involve themselves in discretely collecting information about UFO events such as the Coyame crash retrieval.

Douglass thinks that the author of the “Chihuahua Disk Crash” document, identified as JS, somehow obtained access to written government reports regarding the Coyame crash. JS makes a number of references throughout the document to written sources, such as in stating that “no mention is made of the occupants of the civilian aircraft.” Apparently, JS is summarizing the content of one or more documents in which the events of the Chihuahua crash are described.

Additionally, JS seems to refer to several verbal conversations that have taken place regarding the Coyame event. He refers to several “unconfirmed” reports. This suggests that JS has had a number of conversations with others on the Deneb team, while diligently working to piece together a number of disjointed bits of information they have gathered.

More importantly, JS refers to at least one “eye witness.” Douglass thinks this witness was a government employee or soldier stationed at the Fort Bliss Army Base in 1974. Although the eyewitness was probably not involved in the Coyame recovery operation, apparently he or she watched from afar as the recovery team was assembled and knew some important specifics about the mission. Douglass speculates that the witness may have been a woman, perhaps a civilian employee of the base, because while her observations are detailed and factual, she does not seem to be intimately familiar with the exact models of the aircraft used in the operation. Most male base employees would probably have known the exact type of each aircraft.

The document itself is a fairly straightforward recitation of facts that have been collected by JS and others. There is nothing in the document that sheds light as to what type of position or rank the author may have held at the time of the events described. Again, the document appears to result from efforts by individuals within the government to collect and share bits of classified information about UFOs that they have pieced together from various sources. The author of the document does not seem overly concerned about the possible consequences of being found out by his or her superiors; however, there is clearly an effort to remain anonymous.



Typical Top Secret Document (U.S. Government)

An interesting side note is the designation FILE UFO3263, which appears at the top of the original Chihuahua Disk Crash report. Douglass believes this indicates that the Coyame crash information is only

one of a larger body of carefully cataloged UFO documents. This catalog is obviously maintained by the same clandestine UFO research group consisting of current and former U.S. government employees. One might also infer from the use of the term UFO that this term is actually used in “official” government classified documents, which is something that the U.S. security agencies have steadfastly denied.

Toward what end is this UFO material being assembled and catalogued? Although the information is shared among the members of internal, closed groups, these same members do not seem particularly interested in disclosing what they know to the general public. Douglass believes that this stems from the fact that although they view themselves as deserving to know classified UFO secrets, they do not feel that the general public should know. Due to their positions, they are unable or unwilling to reveal what they know, nor do they want their information indiscriminately trumpeted to the masses by civilian UFO researchers. Thus, the information remains locked away in these quiet little study groups.

Douglass does not believe that *Research Findings on Chihuahua Disk Crash* was leaked by anyone associated with the Deneb team, but rather that a portion of it was stolen from the group and later mailed to civilian UFO investigators, including herself.

According to Douglass, it is also not entirely outside the realm of possibility that the Deneb team was not an informal, unofficial study group but rather an official one, sanctioned by some branch or unit of the U.S. government to uncover facts about the Coyame UFO crash. It is possible that the Deneb team was assembled and tasked by a high government official with a staff, a budget, and the authority to conduct an inquiry into a classified government operation.

Historically, it appears that UFO evidence is such a tightly held secret that it has even been kept from even high elected officials, including possibly the President of the United States. The truth about UFOs is genuinely held to a strict “need to know” doctrine. Therefore, a high government official, feeling out of the loop and at a serious disadvantage on this issue, might desire to conduct an inquiry into specific events such as the Coyame event in an effort to become better educated on the matter.

Let’s suppose that a government official, elected or appointed, desires to uncover UFO evidence that he or she suspects exists. His motivation might be a deep personal interest in the extraterrestrial matter; or, perhaps knowledge of extraterrestrials is seen as a means of advancing his career in government. If a high official amasses a cabinet-full of data on UFO crash retrievals, this information can surely be useful to secure funding, to gain more powerful positions, to sit on influential committees, and so on.



Simulated UFO Set Against Actual Photo of Coyame Desert (by Noe Torres)

Whatever its origin, the Deneb report was clearly not intended for release to the general public. It was meant to be circulated only within the members of the Deneb team. However, it was at some point stolen from the Deneb team, re-typed, and then circulated outside the team. Eventually, someone anonymously mailed out copies of the report to several UFO researchers.

After finishing her analysis of the Deneb report, Elaine Douglass adds this fascinating footnote, "While I was MUFON state director Washington DC, and well before I received the Deneb team document in the mail, I was contacted by an individual recently discharged from the military who told me something of interest indirectly related to the Mexican disk crash."

"The individual told me that while he was in the military, he served with a unit whose function was to go inside foreign countries, perform some task and get out quickly without the government of the foreign country knowing the unit had been there."

Douglass says that she met with her informant, a man in his late thirties, in a Washington D.C. coffee shop, "He showed me his military records, which were in plastic sleeves in a 3-ring binder. He said that the unit he served with was stationed in the United States and was not unique. That is, that there are several such teams in readiness at all times."

Douglass remembers her informant saying that the rapid-deploy missions he had been involved in were always extremely high stress, and that it took the team members a long time after completion of their object to "unwind" and return to normalcy. According to the source, soldiers returning from these stealth missions were tense to the point of irrationality for a long period afterward. Anyone who irritated one of these men was in serious danger of being "punched out" by them.

According to Douglass, the informant did not describe in great detail any specific missions his rapid-deploy teams had performed. Also, he did not state that he himself had been involved in any UFO crash recoveries. However, he did indicate that recovering crashed UFO artifacts would have been well within the scope of the types of missions these groups undertook and had in fact undertaken in the past. "I recall him saying that he and his fellow servicemen used to stay up late at night talking about UFOs and extraterrestrials and wondering what was their ultimate significance," Douglass explains.

Douglass believes that the rapid-deploy stealth team described in the *Research Findings on Chihuahua Disk Crash* document is exactly the type of unit that her anonymous ex-military informant was talking about. The quick incursion into Mexico, the destruction of the evidence, the recovery of the disk, and the clandestine truck convoy from Texas to Atlanta via less-traveled roads were the very kinds of activities described to Douglass by the man she met in Washington, D.C.

"The one thing my informant told me I will never forget—he said his team had standing orders not to return any bodies. On the face of it this would have to include human or extraterrestrial bodies." Douglass feels this could indicate that the U.S. government already has already made a large number of UFO body recoveries and that the recovery of bodies is no longer a priority.

After receiving her copy of the *Chihuahua Disk Crash* report, Douglass immediately passed along a copy of it to Leonard Stringfield, pioneer crash retrieval researcher. Stringfield included the account in his final report on UFO crash retrievals, published in February 1994 and titled *UFO Crash/Retrievals: Search for Proof in a Hall of Mirrors (Status Report IV)*. In publishing the account, Stringfield told his readers that he had previously avoided UFO stories from anonymous sources, but that "there seems to be a legitimacy to the 1974 Chihuahua crash report." Stringfield describe the account as "authoritatively written, using correct military terminology and, of note and unlike a hoax, draws a line between so-called 'hard evidence' and that which is speculative."

In addition to the copy sent to Elaine Douglass, the report was also mailed anonymously to several other UFO researchers in the U.S. and Britain from 1993 to 1996. In his 2005 book *Majic Eyes Only: Earth's Encounters with Extraterrestrial Technology*, UFO researcher Ryan S. Wood states, "The report appears to have been written by a source or sources with intimate knowledge of the incident at issue who desired the release of the evidence to interested parties."

UFO researcher B.J. Booth agrees, "I am sure the informant was not one of a lower rank, or clerical person. There is not any way that one 'not in the loop' could be privy to the type of information that was

covered in the Chihuahua account. In my opinion, and I cannot prove this, I would say that the informant would have been an active military person of high regard who was involved heavily in the actual seizure and relocation of the crash debris - probably military intelligence.”

As there were a number of other UFO reports posted on various bulletin board systems by a “JS” addressed to “All Deneb Team Members,” this appears to have been a clandestine group of UFO researchers, operating possibly within the U.S. government, who were active in the 1980s and early 1990s.

The most striking aspect of the Deneb report is that it sounds entirely plausible. It stands up to careful scrutiny, and even after closely correlating all events to a timeline, plotting on maps all movements described, and carefully checking other facts mentioned therein for historical and logistical accuracy. The information most certainly came from a person or persons who either actually witnessed the events or read original source documents about those events.

“The Coyame case is extremely intriguing, and I have no reason at this time to doubt it,” B.J. Booth says. “This could be one of the very best UFO crash and recovery cases, if more witness corroboration, and documentation could be made available.”

The Deneb report is said to have originated with two eyewitnesses, some illegally copied documents, and one partially destroyed document. The illegal copying was done in 1978, and the person who copied the documents subsequently died. The copied documents apparently contained the written accounts of two persons who witnessed some or all of the events.

It is also noteworthy that Leonard Stringfield recalled first having heard of a Chihuahua, Mexico UFO crash “either in the late 1970s or early 1980s.” That means Stringfield heard the story very shortly after the original documents were leaked, sometime after 1978.

Interestingly, the release of the Deneb report came 18 years after the actual events. That’s about the number of years it would take for individuals who were in their forties in 1974 to reach retirement age. If this report did indeed originate with persons who experienced the events firsthand, it makes sense that they waited until their retirement from military service to disclose.

Whatever it’s exact origin, the Deneb Report remains to this day one of the most amazing and seemingly-credible UFO crash retrieval documents to ever surface. Since precious little additional information about this case has yet surfaced, the Deneb Report, at least for now, is the best record we have of what seems to have been one of the watershed events in the history of mankind – the recovery of extraterrestrial artifacts in the desert of Northern Mexico.

About the Authors

Noe Torres and Ruben Uriarte are the authors of *Mexico’s Roswell: The Chihuahua UFO Crash*, originally published in 2007, with a second edition issued in 2008. The critically-acclaimed book is a detailed study of the 1974 crash of a UFO and a small plane near Coyame, Mexico, and it is available for purchase at all online bookstores and at www.roswellbooks.com.

The authors have been interviewed about this case on numerous radio and TV shows, including *Coast to Coast AM* with George Noory. Their book was featured in an episode of the History Channel’s *UFO Hunters* television series, which first aired in February 2008. Noe and Ruben have also spoken about “Mexico’s Roswell” at many conferences and events, including at the 60th Roswell Anniversary Event in Roswell, New Mexico, in July 2007, and at the Crash Retrieval Conference in November 2007.

The authors have also published a book about a UFO crash retrieval that occurred near Del Rio, Texas, in the 1950s. *The Other Roswell: UFO Crash on the Texas-Mexico Border* tells the amazing story of a retired Air Force Colonel who chased a UFO across Texas in his fighter jet and watched it crash on the south bank of the Rio Grande River.



Noe Torres (left) and Ruben Uriarte (right) at Peguis Canyon, near 1974 UFO Crash Site